

LG BX580

Is the 3D experience finally upon us?

This is LG's first attempt at entering the much hyped world of 3D entertainment. The blu-ray player has a lot of interesting features which includes DLNA, wide codec support, and web content. For testing regular Blu-ray playback we used our standard movies and the player did not disappoint at all. In fact the HQV benchmark returned the highest possible scores in three out of the four benchmark tests we ran - Video resolution loss test, Jaggies test, and Film resolution loss test. Regular DVD playback was where the player faltered most, consistently giving us a grainy picture. The UI was a little laggy and



but upscaling of standard definition content from USB was quite good. As for design and build quality, it was at par with other Blu-ray players we've seen.

We tested 3D playback on the LG Infinia 47LX9500 3D TV. For content we used the IMAX Space Station 3D movie and a Philips 3D blu-ray demo disc. The 3D experience was without much depth perception and not at all immersive. However, our lacklustre experience with 3D could just as

easily be the fact that 3D technology has not yet come of age, and not necessarily the player. At a recommended price of ₹27,990, we feel it's way too much to pay for one additional feature - 3D, especially when you're getting impressive Blu-ray players such as the Sony BDP S370 for under 10k. Of course, if you have a penchant for being on the cutting edge of tech at all times, got for it by all means.

Siddharth Parwatay

Specifications

Connects: HDMI, LAN, Optical, Coaxial, Component/Composite
Audio formats: MP3, WMA
Video formats: Avi, DivX, MPG, MKV, MP4, AVCHD

Contact

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Website: www.lg.com/in/
Price: ₹27,990

7.0
10

Features.....8.0
Performance.....7.5
Build Quality.....7.0
Value for money.....5.0

Specifications

Network: GSM-850 / 900 / 1800 / 1900 MHz; Data: GPRS, EDGE; Screen: 3.2" TFT LCD (Capacitive) @ 240 x 400 pixels; Dimensions: 109.5 x 55 x 11.7mm; Weight: 100g; Battery: 1200mAh Connectivity: Wi-fi 802.11n, BT 3.0

Contact

Samsung India
Phone: 91-124-4881234
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Web site: www.samsung.com/in
Price: ₹8,500

7.0
10

Features.....7.0
Performance.....6.0
Build Quality.....7.0
Value for money.....7.0

Samsung Wave 525

A decent offering for a specific type of user

The Wave 525 is a budget offering from Samsung's line of phones running the bada operating system. The phone is all plastic, but surprisingly manages to look sleek and can easily masquerade as a mid range smart phone, rather than the entry level smart phone that it is. The build is sturdy, the screen is vibrant and the touch response is quite good. Call reception and voice quality is exceptional on the earpiece. Camera quality is at par with other 3.2 MP phone cameras out there, while the on-



phone photo editing features are something to rave about. But apart from these positives, in each and every aspect of the phone there is something or the other lacking. "Almost... but not quite there yet", will be a recurring complaint in your mind. bada OS offers almost every feature you can think of - multitasking, an app store, multiple home screens, widgets and more. But are they any good or just on paper? Let's look at the pre-installed apps - for the most part they do what they're supposed to, but there's hardly any refinement; every-

thing's clunky. What about the app store? Not exactly empty, but finding good apps is a task in itself. The phone multitasks, sure, but turn on Wi-Fi, run a few process intensive apps and stuff begins to lag a little - at times even typing. The Dolphin browser loads full websites and features multiple window browsing, but won't reflow screen size or zoom level. Lots of minor irritants everywhere. Overall this is a phone for those who like to (more or less) use their phones with whatever it comes with, rather than delving into the world of customisation. If you are that sort of a user it's not a bad deal for ₹8,500 approx.

Siddharth Parwatay